

NBZ RESEARCH

Sei Network

Deep-Dive Fundamental Analysis Report

\$SEI · “The Blockchain for Trading” — High-Performance EVM L1

\$0.0398 Price (USD)	\$297.12M Market Cap	\$398.28M FDV	7.46B Circ. Supply (SEI)	#97 CMC Rank
--------------------------------	--------------------------------	-------------------------	------------------------------------	------------------------

Blockchain Layer:	L1 — independent blockchain, now EVM-only (April 2026) after fully retiring its original parallel Cosmos SDK / EVM dual-runtime architecture
Protocol Type:	High-performance Layer-1 purpose-built for trading, order-book DeFi, tokenized assets, stablecoins/payments and AI agentic economies
Founded:	2021 (concept); mainnet launched August 2023, originally on Cosmos SDK with a parallel EVM layer, now fully EVM-only
Total Raised (disclosed):	\$85M across disclosed rounds, implying an \$800M valuation, led by Multicoin Capital, Coinbase Ventures and Circle
Website:	sei.io docs.sei.io

Research by NBZ / NASIR

Institutional-style independent research. Data verified across multiple sources as of August 15, 2026.
Not financial advice.

01 PROJECT OVERVIEW

Field	Detail
Project Name	Sei Network (developed by Sei Labs)
Token Ticker	\$SEI
Blockchain Layer	L1 — an independent, sovereign blockchain. Sei originally launched in 2023 with an unusual dual-runtime architecture running both Cosmos SDK (CosmWasm) and EVM environments in parallel; as of April 2026 it has fully retired the Cosmos side and become a pure, EVM-only L1 ("Sei Giga").
Built On	Native L1, currently EVM-compatible only. Previously built on Cosmos SDK with a parallel EVM layer (2023-early 2026); the Cosmos stack — CosmWasm smart contracts, IBC interoperability, native oracle, bech32 addresses — was fully disabled during the April 6-8, 2026 migration window.
Protocol Type	High-performance Layer-1 purpose-built for trading — onchain order books, tokenized real-world assets, stablecoins/payments, DeFi, and an emerging AI "agentic economies" use case, rather than a general-purpose smart contract chain.
Founded	2021 (concept, by Jayendra Jog and Jeff Feng); Sei Labs headquartered in San Francisco, USA
HQ	San Francisco, California, USA
TGE Date	Mainnet launched August 2023
Contract Address	Native SEI L1 asset; post-EVM-migration addressing uses standard Ethereum-style (0x-prefixed) addresses rather than the original Cosmos bech32 format — verify current bridging/contract details against official docs before interacting
Website	sei.io
Total Raised	\$85.0M disclosed across funding rounds, implying an \$800M valuation, led by Multicoin Capital, Coinbase Ventures and Circle
Circulating Supply	7.46B SEI
Max Supply	10.00B SEI (fixed); total supply 10.00B SEI
Current Focus	Completing and stabilizing the "Sei Giga" EVM-only architecture (targeting 200,000 TPS, sub-400ms finality via the Autobahn multi-proposer consensus engine); deepening TradFi/institutional partnerships (tokenized assets, stablecoin payroll, trading infrastructure) and the AI agentic-economy use case

Sei Network positions itself not as a general-purpose "world computer" blockchain but as specialized infrastructure purpose-built for one thing: trading. Its own website leads with the tagline "The Blockchain for Trading" and "Infrastructure for the Modern Economy," explicitly targeting order-book DeFi, tokenized securities, stablecoin payments, and increasingly the emerging "AI agentic economies" use case — a narrower, more application-specific positioning than most Layer-1 chains attempt.

The problem Sei set out to solve at launch in 2023 was that general-purpose blockchains — including Ethereum, and even faster chains like Solana — were not specifically optimized for the unique demands of financial trading: sub-second finality, native order-book support, and front-running resistance. Sei's original architectural bet was a dual Cosmos-SDK-and-EVM runtime, intended to combine Cosmos's performance advantages with EVM's vastly larger developer ecosystem. By early 2026, the team concluded that this dual-runtime complexity was adding cost without proportional benefit and undertook one of the most consequential architectural changes any major L1 has made: fully retiring the Cosmos side of the network to

become a pure EVM chain — a decision covered in detail in Section 10.

What differentiates Sei most sharply from peers in this research series is the depth and specificity of its institutional and traditional-finance relationships: its own website prominently features quotes from BlackRock's Larry Fink, Nasdaq's Adena Friedman, Visa's Ryan McInerney, and SEC Chairman Paul Atkins, alongside logos for VanEck, Apollo, Brevan Howard, PayPal, Circle, Mastercard, Robinhood, Kalshi and Coinbase. This is a materially different caliber and breadth of named institutional engagement than most projects reviewed in this series claim, though — as with any partnership-logo display — the actual depth of each individual relationship (pilot vs. production integration) should be verified rather than assumed uniform.

02 TEAM & FOUNDERS

Name	Role	Background
Jayendra Jog	Co-Founder	Co-founded Sei Labs and has remained a continuous public spokesperson for the network through mainnet launch, the 2026 Sei Giga upgrade, and the Cosmos-to-EVM migration — publicly explaining the rationale for the migration directly on X ("To make something faster, you either have to add power...").
Jeff Feng	Co-Founder	Co-founded Sei Labs alongside Jog; has maintained public-facing involvement across the network's multi-year development.
Justin Barlow	Head of Business Development & Head of Investments	Leads BD and investment strategy — a dual role suggesting close integration between Sei's ecosystem partnership efforts and its investment/treasury activities.
Jack Lipstone	Head of DeFi Business Development	Focuses specifically on DeFi ecosystem growth and partnerships, relevant to Sei's order-book DeFi and trading-infrastructure positioning.
Chad Huggins	Head of Marketing	Leads marketing and public communications strategy.
Julian Tan	Head of Grants & Head of Liquidity	Oversees the ecosystem grants program and liquidity strategy — directly relevant to bootstrapping DeFi activity on the network.
Jamie H. Finn	Strategic Advisor	Provides strategic guidance to the core team.
Dan Edlebeck	Head of Ecosystem	Leads ecosystem development and builder support.
Alvin Kan	Head of Asia	Leads regional strategy and business development across Asian markets.

Sei's team is notably large and functionally specialized relative to most projects in this research series, with dedicated heads of DeFi BD, grants, liquidity, ecosystem, Asia and marketing in addition to its two continuous co-founders — a structure more typical of a well-resourced, multi-year-operating organization than an early-stage startup. Both co-founders, Jayendra Jog and Jeff Feng, have maintained public, verifiable involvement from the network's 2021 conception through its August 2023 mainnet launch and into the major 2026 Sei Giga/EVM-only transition — a demonstrated multi-year continuity comparable to some of the longer-tenured teams reviewed elsewhere in this series.

Jog's own public explanation of the rationale for abandoning Cosmos — a technically candid, first-principles justification rather than vague marketing language — is a positive signal of transparent, engineering-led communication during a high-stakes architectural transition. Execution risk reads as low-to-moderate: the team successfully completed one of the most technically ambitious infrastructure changes attempted by any major L1 in 2026 (the phased Cosmos-to-EVM migration, detailed in Section 10) without major reported incidents, which is a meaningful positive data point for execution capability, though the team's ability to convert this technical achievement into renewed market and developer mindshare — an area where independent analysis flags Sei has recently lost ground — remains the primary open question.

03 TECHNOLOGY & ARCHITECTURE

Component	Description
Current architecture	Pure EVM-only Layer-1 as of April 2026 ("Sei Giga"); previously a dual-runtime chain running Cosmos SDK/CosmWasm and EVM environments in parallel from its August 2023 launch.
Consensus engine	Autobahn — a multi-proposer consensus architecture (distinct from standard single-proposer Tendermint-style consensus), achieving a reported 50x throughput improvement over Tendermint while maintaining Byzantine Fault Tolerance.
Performance targets	Up to 200,000 transactions per second, sub-400ms settlement finality — for comparison, Visa's network processes roughly 24,000 TPS at peak load and Solana targets a theoretical 65,000 TPS.
Migration process (SIP-3)	A community-approved, phased de-Cosmos-ification: v6.3 (Jan 2026) enabled EVM-based staking; v6.4 (Apr 13, 2026) shipped the technical capability to disable inbound IBC transfers; v6.5 (Mar 2026, per some sources) removed Sei's native oracle, replacing it with Chainlink, API3 and Pyth; the final migration window (Apr 6-8, 2026) fully disabled the remaining Cosmos stack — CosmWasm contracts, IBC, native oracle, bech32 addresses.
Oracle infrastructure	Now provided by established third-party providers Chainlink, API3 and Pyth, replacing Sei's own native oracle solution as part of the EVM-only simplification.
Order-book architecture	A core original differentiator — native onchain order books designed to let decentralized exchanges run at speeds closer to centralized trading platforms than typical AMM-based DEXs.
Migration impact on users	Automatic for centralized-exchange users; self-custody wallet holders needed to manually migrate; roughly \$1.4M in Cosmos-native USDC.n required conversion via a dedicated migration tool routing through Noble, Polygon and Circle's CCTP v2 before the deadline, or risked losing access

In plain terms, Sei originally tried to have it both ways: run a Cosmos-based environment optimized for raw performance, while also offering an EVM environment so Ethereum-native developers could deploy familiar smart contracts without learning new tools. By early 2026, the team concluded this dual approach was creating unnecessary complexity — maintaining two parallel technical stacks, two developer experiences, and duplicated infrastructure — without a proportional payoff, since "EVM won the developer gravity war" (per one industry analysis) as the vast majority of tooling, wallets, bridges and available developer talent had already consolidated around EVM industry-wide.

The resulting migration was executed with unusual technical discipline: rather than a single abrupt cutover, Sei rolled out the change across four distinct phases over roughly four months (January-April 2026), each removing one specific piece of Cosmos-stack dependency (staking, then IBC transfers, then the native oracle, then the remaining core Cosmos transaction types) — described by one analysis as deleting "hundreds of thousands of lines of code" from the protocol. This phased approach, plus advance coordination with major custodians like Coinbase (which suspended SEI deposits/withdrawals during the final migration window) and wallet providers, reflects a genuinely careful, risk-managed execution of what one source called "an architectural amputation" — a materially different approach than a rushed or poorly communicated migration might have taken.

This full migration is directly comparable to, and materially more advanced than, Secret Network's own currently-proposed (and still unresolved, as of this report) Arbitrum migration reviewed elsewhere in this series — Sei's transition is complete and live, offering a useful real-world precedent for how markets and users respond to a major L1 successfully executing this kind of architectural overhaul, rather than merely proposing one.

04

USE CASES & REAL-WORLD APPLICATIONS

Use Case	Description	Status
Onchain trading / order books	Native order-book infrastructure for decentralized exchanges seeking centralized-exchange-like execution speed.	Live
Stablecoins & payments	Toku launched a Sei-native stablecoin payroll product (Feb 2026), enabling instant employee/remittance payments settled onchain rather than through days-long traditional bank rails.	Live
Tokenized assets	Positioned as core infrastructure for tokenized securities, aligned with public statements from BlackRock's Larry Fink and Nasdaq's Adena Friedman featured directly on Sei's own website.	Live / growing
Decentralized Finance (DeFi)	General DeFi activity — lending, trading, liquidity provision — leveraging the network's speed advantages.	Live
AI & agentic economies	An emerging, explicitly named use-case category on Sei's own site, targeting high-frequency AI trading agents and automated onchain decision-making at scale.	Early / emerging
Institutional / TradFi integrations	Named partner logos include VanEck, Apollo, Brevan Howard, PayPal, Chainlink, Circle, CoinShares, Securitize, Mastercard, Ondo, Robinhood, Kalshi, Coinbase and Privy — spanning asset managers, payment giants, and tokenization infrastructure providers.	Mixed maturity
Robinhood listing	SEI was listed on Robinhood in October 2025, expanding retail accessibility to a large mainstream brokerage user base.	Live
Spot ETF filing	Canary Capital filed for the first spot SEI exchange-traded fund with the SEC in 2025; as of the most recent sources reviewed, it had not yet been approved.	Pending

Sei's use-case profile is distinguished by genuinely notable breadth of institutional and TradFi engagement relative to most projects in this research series — the Robinhood listing, the pending Canary Capital spot ETF filing, and the roster of named partner logos (BlackRock-adjacent commentary, Nasdaq, Visa, Mastercard, PayPal, Circle) collectively suggest Sei has achieved a level of mainstream financial-industry visibility that few other L1s of comparable market cap have reached. The Toku stablecoin payroll launch is a particularly concrete, named example of live, working payments infrastructure rather than a purely aspirational partnership.

That said, independent June 2026 analysis (CoinStats AI) offers an important caution directly relevant to interpreting these signals: while Sei shows "headline metrics of rising transaction counts and active addresses, the quality of that adoption is unclear," specifically flagging that "some ecosystem growth may be subsidized by grants and liquidity incentives" — a pattern worth weighing against the otherwise impressive partnership roster. The most credible, differentiated near-term demand driver is the AI agentic-economy use case, which directly leverages Sei's core speed advantage (high-frequency automated trading/decision-making genuinely benefits from sub-400ms finality in a way many other use cases do not), though this remains an early-stage, still-developing narrative rather than a proven revenue driver.

05 COMMUNITY & ECOSYSTEM

Metric	Data
Mainnet launch	August 2023
Market cap at time of EVM migration announcement	~\$800M (January 2026)
Robinhood listing	October 2025 — expanded retail accessibility significantly
Spot ETF filing status	Canary Capital filed for the first spot SEI ETF with the SEC in 2025; not yet approved as of the most recent sources reviewed
2026 mindshare trend	CoinGecko's 2026 ecosystem report explicitly states Sei "lost mindshare in 2025 and was displaced from the top tier of popular blockchains" — a directly negative, independently sourced signal worth weighing against the strong partnership roster
TVL trend	Independent May 2026 analysis (WEEX) flags "the collapse of TVL from its peaks" as "a major concern for investors" — indicating significant TVL decline from earlier highs
Notable partner/backer logos (per official site)	VanEck, Apollo, Brevan Howard, PayPal, Chainlink, Circle, CoinShares, Securitize, Mastercard, Ondo, Robinhood, Kalshi, Coinbase, Privy, Binance
Community-notable event	Sei Foundation reportedly explored a bid for bankrupt genetic-testing firm 23andMe to bring consumer DNA data onchain (reported by Fortune, per Sei's own site referencing the coverage) — an unusual, headline-generating initiative distinct from typical DeFi/infrastructure news
Exchange listings	KuCoin, Binance, Coinbase, Hotcoin, LBank, Bitrue, BigONE, Bybit, Backpack, Robinhood, and others

Sei's community and ecosystem picture contains a genuine tension worth sitting with rather than resolving prematurely: on one hand, its institutional and mainstream-finance visibility (Robinhood listing, pending ETF filing, a genuinely broad and credible-looking partner-logo roster) exceeds what most comparably-sized L1s have achieved. On the other hand, independent, non-Sei-affiliated analysis explicitly documents both a mindshare decline (per CoinGecko's own 2026 ecosystem report) and a TVL collapse from earlier peaks — two of the most direct, unfavorable signals found anywhere in the sources reviewed for this research series.

This combination suggests Sei may be a case where headline institutional partnerships and retail distribution (Robinhood) have not yet translated into durable, organic on-chain ecosystem strength — consistent with the CoinStats AI observation that some ecosystem growth may be incentive-subsidized rather than purely organic. The successful completion of the EVM-only migration (Section 03) is explicitly framed by multiple sources as the primary catalyst analysts are watching for a potential "market recovery in mid-2026" — meaning the technical achievement of the migration has not yet, on its own, reversed the mindshare and TVL trends documented above as of the most recent sources reviewed.

06 INVESTORS & PARTNERSHIPS

Round	Amount	Implied Valuation	Lead Investor(s)
Combined disclosed rounds	\$85.0M	\$800M	Multicoin Capital, Coinbase Ventures, Circle

Tier	Investor	Type
Tier 1	Multicoin Capital (Lead)	Venture
Tier 1	Coinbase Ventures (Lead)	Exchange
Tier 1	Circle (Lead)	Venture / Corporation
Tier 2	GSR	Venture / Market Maker
Tier 2	OKX Ventures	Exchange
Tier 2	Delphi Ventures	Venture
Tier 2	Hypersphere Ventures	Venture
Tier 2	Jump Crypto	Venture
Tier 2	MH Ventures	Venture
Tier 2	Distributed Global	Venture
Tier 2	Mapleblock Capital	Venture
Tier 3	Foresight Ventures	Venture
Tier 3	Cypher Capital	Venture
Tier 3	Bixin Ventures	Venture
Tier 3	No Limit Holdings	Venture
Tier 3	Hyperithm	Venture
Tier 3	Bitget	Exchange
Tier 4	Aegis Ventures	Venture
Tier 4	Asymmetric Capital	Venture
Other	Flow Traders	Market Maker / Corporation
Other	Hudson River Trading	Market Maker / Corporation

Sei's investor roster is among the strongest and most specifically relevant of any project in this research series, precisely because of its composition: alongside Tier-1 crypto-native funds (Multicoin Capital, Coinbase Ventures), the round includes Circle — the issuer of USDC and a genuinely major TradFi/stablecoin infrastructure player — as a co-lead, directly reinforcing Sei's stablecoin-payments positioning. Just as notably, two of the world's largest high-frequency trading and market-making firms, Flow Traders and Hudson River Trading, are listed as backers — a highly unusual and specifically relevant signal for a chain explicitly positioned around "The Blockchain for Trading," since these firms bring direct expertise in the exact market-microstructure problems Sei's order-book architecture is designed to solve.

The strategic value of this investor base extends well beyond capital: Circle's involvement plausibly underpins Sei's stablecoin/payments traction (including the Toku payroll launch and Circle's CCTP v2 being used directly in the network's own EVM migration tooling), while Flow Traders' and Hudson River Trading's participation lends genuine institutional trading credibility that is difficult for competing L1s to replicate without similarly specific backers. This is a more thematically coherent, trading-specific investor roster than most general-purpose L1s assemble.

07 TOKENOMICS

Parameter	Value
Max Supply	10,000,000,000 SEI (fixed)
Total Supply	10.00B SEI
Circulating Supply	7.46B SEI (~74.6% of max supply)
Mainnet launch	August 2023
Unlocked Market Cap	Equal to current Market Cap (\$297.12M) per this report's snapshot, indicating the large majority of circulating supply is fully unlocked and freely tradable

Category	%	Notes
Ecosystem Reserve	27.00%	The largest single allocation — funds ongoing ecosystem growth, grants, and development incentives
Private Sale Investors	20.00%	Allocation to the institutional investors listed in Section 06
Team (Years 2-4)	15.20%	Core team allocation vesting across years 2 through 4 post-launch
Staking Rewards	15.00%	Funds ongoing validator/staking incentive payments
Team (Years 5-6)	4.80%	A further tranche of team allocation vesting later, in years 5 and 6 post-launch — reflecting an extended, multi-year vesting structure
Foundation	9.00%	Sei Development Foundation treasury, supporting the network's U.S.-based non-profit growth and awareness initiatives
Strategic Allocation	3.00%	Reserved for strategic partnerships and initiatives
Airdrop	3.00%	Direct community distribution at or around launch
Binance Launchpool	3.00%	Allocation distributed via Binance's Launchpool staking program, a mechanism providing broad initial retail distribution and exchange-level visibility

SEI's allocation is dominated by the Ecosystem Reserve (27.00%), reflecting a strategy of using a large portion of supply to fund ongoing growth and incentive programs rather than concentrating allocation purely among insiders — though combined Private Sale Investors (20.00%) and Team (15.20% + 4.80% = 20.00% total, split across two distinct vesting tranches) still total 40% of supply, a substantial insider allocation comparable to other venture-backed projects reviewed in this series. The unusually granular team-vesting structure — split explicitly into a Years 2-4 tranche and a separate, later Years 5-6 tranche — suggests an extended, multi-year vesting commitment designed to align the team's economic interests with the network's long-term success well beyond a typical shorter cliff-and-vest schedule.

The relatively modest, broad-based Airdrop (3.00%) and Binance Launchpool (3.00%) allocations reflect a fairly standard, moderate approach to initial retail distribution — not as generous as some community-first launches, but providing genuine initial liquidity and exchange visibility via the Launchpool mechanism specifically. With circulating supply already at roughly 74.6% of max supply and unlocked market cap equal to total market cap in this report's snapshot, SEI shows less near-term unlock overhang risk than several newer projects reviewed in this series, though the ongoing Team (Years 5-6) tranche and continued Staking Rewards emissions represent a longer-tail, gradual dilution source extending well beyond the network's original launch.

08 MARKET OVERVIEW

Metric	Value
Current Price	~\$0.0398 (exchange pairs ranged \$0.03978-\$0.03989 across KuCoin, Binance, Coinbase, Hotcoin, LBank, Bittrue, BigONE, Bybit, Backpack)
24h Range	\$0.03949 - \$0.04027
Market Cap	\$297.12M
Unlocked Market Cap	\$297.12M (equal to Market Cap in this snapshot)
Fully Diluted Market Cap	\$398.28M
24h Volume	\$9.09M
Circulating / Total Supply	7.46B / 10.00B SEI
All-Time High	\$1.141 (reached March 2024, per independent analysis)
All-Time Low	\$0.007989
CMC Rank	#97 (general), #123 (on the project-specific market page referenced)
Key Exchange Listings	Binance, Coinbase, KuCoin, Bybit, Hotcoin, LBank, Bittrue, BigONE, Backpack, Robinhood

SEI's price history shows one of the more severe drawdowns in this research series in percentage terms: from its March 2024 all-time high of \$1.141 down to the roughly \$0.0398 level captured in this report — a decline of well over 96%. Independent May 2026 analysis specifically priced SEI at approximately \$0.07 at that time, describing it as "down 94% from its March 2024 all-time high" while noting the project was "simultaneously executing its most ambitious technical upgrade and trading near historical lows" — a striking juxtaposition of strong technical execution against weak price performance that continued through to this report's August 2026 snapshot, where price has declined further still toward its all-time low of \$0.007989.

This pattern — genuine, well-executed technical achievement (the completed EVM migration) failing to translate into price recovery — is a notable and somewhat unusual data point relative to other cases in this series. Internet Computer's Mission 70 tokenomics announcement, for comparison, triggered an immediate positive price reaction; Sei's comparably significant architectural achievement does not appear to have produced a similar re-rating as of the most recent data reviewed, consistent with the independently documented mindshare and TVL declines discussed in Section 05. This divergence between technical execution and market reception is arguably the single most important open question for anyone evaluating SEI at this time.

Current 24h volume of \$9.09M against a \$297.12M market cap represents a moderate ~3% turnover ratio, indicating steady but not especially high trading conviction at the time of this snapshot — consistent with a token that has settled into a subdued, lower-momentum trading pattern following its extended decline from 2024 highs.

09

COMPETITORS & MARKET POSITION

Project	Type / Chain	Market Cap	vs. Sei Network
Solana	High-throughput monolithic L1	Vastly larger — dominant high-performance non-EVM chain	The clear category benchmark, with \$8.3B+ TVL (3rd-largest chain overall), the deepest DeFi ecosystem (Jupiter, Raydium, Kamino), and roughly 2,100 monthly active full-time developers per the Electric Capital 2025 Developer Report — Sei's core competitive challenge is convincing developers and liquidity to choose it over the already-dominant Solana
Monad	High-performance parallelized EVM L1	Comparable/smaller, well-funded (\$225M raised)	Sei's most directly comparable EVM-performance competitor, targeting 10,000+ TPS with full EVM compatibility; launched mainnet Nov 2025 and is, per independent analysis, still in its early ecosystem-building phase as of mid-2026 — a genuine head-to-head rival for the same "fastest EVM chain" positioning Sei claims
Sui / Aptos	Move-language parallel-execution L1s	Comparable, with strong institutional traction	Direct competitors for the "next-gen Layer 1" institutional narrative; Sui in particular has secured its own notable TradFi pilot (a Visa programmable-payments pilot in Q4 2025) and posted 297 million transactions in a single day during a November 2025 gaming event — a genuine, credible competing claim to institutional and high-throughput credibility
Ethereum L2s (Arbitrum, Base)	Rollups on Ethereum	Larger, benefit from Ethereum's security/liquidity	Offer lower fees without requiring developers to leave the broader Ethereum ecosystem and its liquidity — a persistent structural alternative for developers who might otherwise consider a standalone high-performance L1 like Sei
Hyperliquid	Vertically-integrated perp DEX, own L1	Multi-billion, market leader in on-chain derivatives	A different category leader specifically within the trading-infrastructure niche Sei targets, demonstrating that a narrowly-focused trading chain can achieve category dominance — a template Sei has not yet replicated within its own order-book/trading positioning

Sei occupies a genuinely crowded and increasingly contested part of the market: the "high-performance L1 for trading/finance" category now includes Solana (the dominant incumbent), Monad (a well-funded, directly comparable EVM-performance challenger), Sui and Aptos (Move-based parallel-execution chains with their own credible institutional traction), and specialized trading-native chains like Hyperliquid that have already achieved category dominance within a narrower niche. Independent analysis directly frames this as "a genuine zero-sum fight for technical talent and protocol-level network effects" given a roughly flat, constrained global pool of about 23,000 full-time Web3 developers as of the most recent Electric Capital report cited.

Sei's moat, to the extent one exists, is the combination of its genuinely differentiated institutional/TradFi partnership breadth (Section 06) and its now-completed, technically ambitious EVM-only architecture — few competitors can claim both a

comparable roster of named financial-industry relationships and a similarly aggressive, already-executed performance-optimization overhaul. The moat is meaningfully undermined, however, by the independently documented mindshare and TVL declines discussed in Section 05, and by Tracxn's own competitive positioning data ranking Sei 1,320th among 1,300 active tracked competitors with a listed "\$0" disclosed funding figure in that specific database — a discrepancy from the \$85M figure cited by other sources that likely reflects differing data-collection methodologies, but underscores that even basic competitive benchmarking data for Sei varies meaningfully across trackers.

The biggest structural threat is the sheer density of well-funded, technically credible competitors chasing the same "fastest EVM chain" and "chain for institutional finance" positioning simultaneously (Monad, Sui, MegaETH, and others per CoinStats AI's June 2026 analysis) — meaning even a well-executed technical differentiator like Sei Giga may only provide a temporary, quickly-eroded advantage rather than a durable moat, absent continued execution and genuine (not purely incentive-driven) ecosystem growth.

10 RECENT NEWS & UPDATES

Date	Event
2021	Sei Network founded by Jayendra Jog and Jeff Feng
Aug 2023	Sei mainnet launches, built on Cosmos SDK with a parallel EVM execution layer, explicitly positioned as "the blockchain for trading"
Mar 2024	SEI reaches its all-time high of \$1.141 amid the broader 2024 crypto bull market
Mar 27, 2025	Sei Foundation reportedly explores a bid for bankrupt genetic-testing firm 23andMe, aiming to bring consumer DNA data onchain (per Fortune)
Apr 2, 2025	Sei Foundation announces the funding of the Sei Development Foundation, a US-based non-profit focused on growth and awareness of the Sei protocol
2025 (mid-year)	The Sei community approves SIP-3 via governance vote, authorizing the deprecation of CosmWasm smart contracts and native Cosmos transactions in favor of a fully EVM-only architecture
2025 (2H)	Canary Capital files for the first spot SEI exchange-traded fund with the SEC; not yet approved as of the most recent sources reviewed
Oct 2025	SEI is listed on Robinhood, significantly expanding retail accessibility
Jan 17, 2026	Sei Labs commits to a mid-2026 deadline to complete the EVM-only transition under the "Sei Giga" upgrade; co-founder Jayendra Jog publicly explains the technical rationale on X; market cap sits at roughly \$800M at this time
Jan 2026	Version 6.3 deploys, enabling staking functionality through the EVM layer
Mar 2026	Version 6.5 deploys, removing Sei's native oracle and replacing it with Chainlink, API3 and Pyth
Apr 13, 2026	Version 6.4 deploys to mainnet, shipping the technical capability to disable inbound IBC transfers; SEI trades at \$0.056 with an ~\$382M market cap at this time
Apr 6-8, 2026	Final migration window: the full Cosmos stack (CosmWasm, IBC, native oracle, bech32 addresses) is disabled; Sei becomes a pure EVM-only chain; Coinbase suspends SEI deposits/withdrawals during the transition window; users holding ~\$1.4M in Cosmos-native USDC.n must complete migration via a Noble/Polygon/CCTP v2 routing tool or risk losing access
Feb 12, 2026	Toku launches a Sei-native stablecoin payroll product, enabling instant employee and remittance payments settled onchain
Jun 2026	Independent CoinStats AI analysis flags that CoinGecko's 2026 ecosystem report documents Sei losing mindshare in 2025 and being displaced from the top tier of popular blockchains
Aug 15, 2026 (snapshot)	SEI trading around \$0.0398, market cap ~\$297M, down further from its already-depressed mid-2026 levels and far below its March 2024 all-time high

The news timeline reveals a team capable of genuinely major, disciplined technical execution: the phased, four-stage Cosmos-to-EVM migration was planned, communicated, and completed within its committed timeframe, with proactive coordination with major custodians and clear user guidance for the affected minority holding Cosmos-native assets — a rare example in this research series of a major architectural change actually being completed as announced, rather than remaining a pending or unresolved proposal (contrast with Secret Network's still-pending Arbitrum migration, reviewed elsewhere in this series).

The most defining events are the completed EVM-only migration itself and the accompanying institutional momentum (Robinhood listing, pending ETF filing, Toku payroll launch) — yet the timeline also reveals a persistent, unresolved tension:

none of these genuinely positive, verifiable developments have yet translated into price recovery or reversed the independently documented mindshare and TVL declines. This gap between operational execution and market/ecosystem reception is the central story this news timeline tells, and is the most important context for evaluating SEI's forward-looking prospects.

11 INVESTMENT POTENTIAL & RISKS

BULL CASE

- + Successfully completed one of the most technically ambitious architecture changes attempted by any major L1 in 2026 — a full, phased Cosmos-to-EVM migration executed on schedule with no major reported incidents
- + Genuinely differentiated breadth of institutional and TradFi engagement (VanEck, Apollo, Brevan Howard, PayPal, Circle, Mastercard, Robinhood, plus public commentary from BlackRock's Larry Fink and Nasdaq's Adena Friedman)
- + Uniquely relevant investor base for a trading-focused chain, including major market makers Flow Traders and Hudson River Trading alongside Circle, Multicoïn Capital and Coinbase Ventures
- + Ambitious, credible performance targets (200,000 TPS, sub-400ms finality via the Autobahn multi-proposer consensus engine) that would represent a genuine step-change if achieved at scale under real conditions
- + Concrete, live use cases beyond speculation — the Toku stablecoin payroll launch is genuine working payments infrastructure, not merely an announced pilot
- + Robinhood listing (Oct 2025) and pending Canary Capital spot ETF filing both expand mainstream, non-crypto-native accessibility
- + Relatively low near-term unlock overhang, with circulating supply already at ~74.6% of max supply and unlocked market cap equal to total market cap in this report's snapshot
- + Continuous, publicly engaged founder leadership (Jayendra Jog, Jeff Feng) since the network's 2021 conception through the 2026 architectural transition

BEAR CASE

- Trading down more than 96% from its March 2024 all-time high, with price continuing to decline even after the successful completion of the major EVM migration — a notable divergence between technical execution and market reception
- Independent, non-Sei-affiliated analysis (CoinGecko's own 2026 ecosystem report, per CoinStats AI) explicitly documents Sei losing mindshare in 2025 and being displaced from the top tier of popular blockchains
- Independent analysis (WEEX) flags a significant TVL collapse from earlier peaks as "a major concern for investors"
- Faces an unusually crowded, well-funded competitive field simultaneously — Solana (dominant incumbent), Monad (directly comparable EVM-performance rival with \$225M raised), Sui and Aptos (with their own credible institutional traction) — in a zero-sum fight for a roughly flat global developer pool
- Some ecosystem growth may be subsidized by grants and liquidity incentives rather than purely organic demand, per independent analysis, making headline transaction/address metrics harder to interpret at face value
- The "fastest blockchain" narrative erodes quickly as a competitive advantage since every new entrant in this category claims similar performance breakthroughs
- Basic competitive-benchmarking data for Sei varies meaningfully across third-party trackers (e.g., Tracxn's very different funding and competitive-ranking figures versus other sources), complicating independent verification of some claims
- The AI agentic-economy use case, while a credible and differentiated fit for Sei's speed advantages, remains an early-stage, largely unproven revenue and demand driver as of this report

Risk Factor	Detailed Explanation
Execution-reception divergence	Sei has demonstrated it can execute genuinely difficult technical projects (the EVM migration) without this translating into price recovery or reversed mindshare/TVL declines — raising the question of whether further technical wins alone will be sufficient to change the trajectory.

Risk Factor	Detailed Explanation
Crowded, well-funded competitive field	Sei must simultaneously compete with Solana's entrenched dominance, Monad's comparable and well-funded EVM-performance positioning, and Sui/Aptos's own credible institutional traction — a harder multi-front competitive position than most single-category L1 competitors face.
Incentive-dependent growth risk	Independent analysis flags that some ecosystem growth metrics may be subsidized by grants and liquidity incentives, raising the risk that headline activity figures overstate durable, organic demand.
Mindshare and TVL decline	Independently documented mindshare loss and TVL collapse from peaks represent real, currently unresolved headwinds that predate and persist alongside the EVM migration's completion.
Data inconsistency across trackers	Meaningful discrepancies in basic competitive and funding data across sources (e.g., Tracxn's very different figures) complicate fully independent verification of some claims made elsewhere.
Institutional partnership depth uncertainty	While the roster of partner logos is broad and genuinely impressive, the depth and production status of each individual relationship (full integration vs. early pilot vs. brand association) is not uniformly detailed in the sources reviewed and would benefit from direct verification.

NBZ RESEARCH VERDICT

Sei Network presents an unusually clear case study in the gap between technical execution and market reception. On pure execution, Sei has genuinely delivered: a phased, disciplined, fully completed migration from a complex dual-runtime architecture to a streamlined, high-performance EVM-only chain, backed by one of the more thematically coherent and credible institutional investor and partnership rosters in this research series, including direct involvement from Circle and major market-making firms uniquely relevant to its trading-infrastructure positioning. Concrete use cases like the Toku stablecoin payroll launch and the Robinhood listing further support that Sei is not merely a speculative narrative chain. Yet none of this has, as of this report, reversed a documented decline in mindshare and TVL, nor prevented the token from trading down more than 96% from its 2024 highs — a genuinely puzzling divergence worth taking seriously rather than assuming will self-correct. Whether Sei is worth attention going forward depends on whether the completed Sei Giga architecture can convert its performance advantages and institutional relationships into renewed, organic (not purely incentive-driven) developer and liquidity growth, in an increasingly crowded field of well-funded high-performance L1 competitors. The most critical risks are the currently crowded competitive landscape and the unresolved question of whether Sei's genuine technical and institutional strengths can overcome an already-documented mindshare deficit. This is a case where strong fundamentals and weak market reception currently coexist, and resolving that tension — in either direction — is the key thing to watch. Not financial advice.

SOURCES CONSULTED: sei.io · docs.sei.io · blog.sei.io · seiresearch.io · Tangem Learning Hub (Sei Cosmos-to-EVM migration guide) · Cryptopolitan · BydFi (SEI Price 2026 analysis) · BingX News · MEXC News · BlockEden.xyz · CoinStats AI (Sei investment analysis, June 2026) · WEEX Questions (Sei 2026 market analysis) · Tracxn (SEI company profile) · Altrady (Monad investor guide, comparative context) · Yellow.com (Monad/Sui/Solana comparison) · Coin Bureau (Sei Network Review 2026) · Fortune (23andMe coverage) · user-supplied CoinMarketCap-style app screenshots (SEI market stats, allocations, exchange markets, team, investor list). Prices, TVL, funding and market data are point-in-time snapshots as of August 15, 2026 and change continuously; several figures (total funding, competitive rankings) vary meaningfully across third-party trackers and should be verified independently before making decisions.

NOT FINANCIAL ADVICE.